

Cat Litter Box Rescue Guide — Action Checklist

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MEDICAL CHECK — RULE OUT HEALTH PROBLEMS FIRST

- ❑ **Schedule a Vet Urinalysis Within 3 Days:** Peeing outside the box is a medical signal before it's a behavioral one. A urinalysis rules out UTI, bladder stones, FLUTD, and kidney disease — the most common medical causes.
- ❑ **Request a Blood Panel If Your Cat Is Middle-Aged or Older:** Kidney disease and diabetes both cause increased urination that owners mistake for behavioral problems. A basic blood panel costs \$80-\$150 and gives you a clean baseline or an early warning.
- ❑ **Watch for These Signs That Need an Emergency Vet Visit:** Straining to pee with little output, crying while in the box, blood in urine, or lethargy combined with not eating. These are not wait-and-see symptoms — they indicate a potential blockage.
- ❑ **Ask Your Vet to Rule Out Diabetes and Hyperthyroidism:** Both conditions increase water intake and urination volume. If your cat is drinking more and peeing more, these are on the differential diagnosis list alongside UTI.

BOX SETUP — CREATE THE RIGHT ENVIRONMENT

- ❑ **Switch to an Uncovered Box That's 1.5x Your Cat's Body Length:** Most store-bought boxes are too small. A storage tote with a cut-out entrance gives most cats enough room to turn around and dig without their back touching the walls.
- ❑ **Follow the N+1 Rule for Box Count:** One box per cat, plus one extra. In a two-cat home, that means three boxes on separate floors with at least two escape routes each — cats don't want to feel cornered mid-elimination.
- ❑ **Use Unscented Clumping Litter at 2 Inches Deep, Scooped Daily:** Scented litters repel cats with sensitive noses. Unscented clumping litter at the right depth prevents paw-pad discomfort and makes daily scooping fast enough to actually happen.
- ❑ **Keep Every Litter Box Away From Food Bowls and Loud Appliances:** Cats evolved to eliminate away from their food source. Boxes near refrigerators, washers, or furnaces get avoided — the sound and vibration feel threatening during a vulnerable moment.

RECOVERY PLAN — 30-DAY RESET WITH MILESTONES

- ☐ **Soak Accident Spots With Cat-Specific Enzymatic Cleaner for 15 Minutes Before Blotting:** Generic cleaners leave uric acid residue that cats can still smell. A cat-labeled enzymatic formula (Rocco & Roxie or similar) breaks it down fully — let it sit 15 minutes, then blot, never scrub.
- ☐ **Run a Feliway Diffuser in the Room Where Accidents Happened Most:** Feliway mimics the calming facial pheromone cats leave when they feel safe. One diffuser covers about 700 square feet and takes 2-3 weeks to reach full effectiveness — don't judge it before day 21.
- ☐ **Add a Third Box in the Area With the Most Accidents Before Day 14:** Extra boxes catch more of the house and give cats options. Place this third box in the most accident-prone area, not in a remote corner the cat already avoids.
- ☐ **Book a Follow-Up Vet Visit at Day 30 If Accidents Haven't Stopped Completely:** Medical and environmental fixes take 3-4 weeks to show full effect. If you're not at 90% improvement by day 30, go back to the vet or ask for a referral to a veterinary behaviorist.

Companion to the full guide in your Lemon Squeezy library — check off each item as you complete it.